DAY 1 / PREPARATION

Get the room ready

The order: clean and repair; then prepare surfaces; then two grey wall coats; then white cupboard; then white skirting; then tidy up. Leave the ceiling and entrance door as they are.

A comfortable schedule: allow three days, with breaks while things dry. The filler needs about 24 hours before painting; deep repairs or a cold room can take longer.

1. Clear and protect

Both: move furniture out or into the centre, leaving room to reach every wall. Cover the carpet with the backed dust sheets, overlapping them. Remove cupboard handles and store the screws together. Protect the radiator, sockets and entrance door. Use a stable stepladder for high edges.

2. Clean before sanding

Andy: wash the walls. **Sarah:** wash the cupboard and skirting. Dilute the sugar soap as its label says, wear gloves, then wipe with clean water. Keep water away from electrical fittings. Let everything dry completely before filling or painting.

3. Remove wall plugs and fill holes

Andy: for ordinary plastic wall plugs, screw a matching screw in just enough to grip, then gently pull the screw with the pliers. Do not drive it deep enough to expand the plug. If stubborn, recess the plug slightly and fill over it rather than tearing the plaster or drilling first.
Sarah: remove loose material and dust, then press filler into the holes with a filling knife and smooth slightly proud. Follow the tub for repair depth; build deep holes in layers if required.

4. Leave the filler to cure

Langlow ready mixed filler is surface dry in about **1-2 hours**, but fully cures in about **24 hours at 20°C**. Plan to sand and paint it the following day, only when hard and dry throughout. Add more time for deep repairs, cold or damp conditions.

Before you start: have a vacuum, cloths, bucket, gloves, screwdriver and safe access available. The plan assumes sound, previously painted wood. Bare wood needs suitable primer; a laminate/melamine cupboard needs a compatible adhesion primer. Check the surface before using the satin. Primer is an extra if needed.

Prepare, then paint grey

5. Sand and remove every trace of dust

Both: use a sanding block each. Sand dry filler gently with **P120** until flush; feather rough edges without hollowing the repair. Lightly dull glossy cupboard and skirting paint with **P240**. Avoid the coarse P40/P80 sheets for this job. Wear the dust masks while sanding. Vacuum, then wipe with a barely damp cloth and let dry. Do all sanding before the wall coats.

6. Prime repairs where needed

Spot-prime bare wood with a suitable wood primer and follow its recoat time. For exposed plaster or absorbent filler, follow the Valspar tin instructions for sealing/priming repairs. Let this dry before the full wall coat. Add a further day if the primer needs it; do not guess a universal drying time.

7. First coat of Valspar Grey Shingle Matt

Stir the paint thoroughly. Protect edges with tape only on sound, fully cured surfaces; test a small area first. **Andy:** brush a narrow band around the ceiling line, corners, cupboard and fittings. **Sarah:** follow with the large roller while the brushed edge is still wet. Work one wall at a time, top to bottom, overlapping strokes lightly. Swap jobs as you like. Two large rollers are useful on open sections, but keep the edging just ahead of rolling.

8. Wait, then apply the second wall coat

The listed recoat time is **2-4 hours**. Plan for **at least 4 hours after finishing coat one**, and longer if it is still damp or the room is cool. Repeat the same edging-and-rolling method. A thin, even coat is better than a heavy one. Check coverage once dry; a patchy area may need another coat after the same wait.

9. Leave the walls overnight

Remove masking tape gently at the stage recommended on its pack, before it becomes trapped under a hard paint edge. Do not put ordinary masking tape onto fresh wall paint tomorrow: it can lift the finish. For the white woodwork, use a steady brush or a clean paint shield instead.

Example timing: finish sanding and priming first. If coat one finishes at 11 am, start coat two no earlier than 3 pm, provided the wall is dry and the tin agrees. If preparation takes longer, move the second coat to the next day.

During breaks: wrap rollers and brushes tightly for a short same-day pause. Keep grey and white tools separate. Keep the room gently ventilated and within the temperature range on the tins; do not force drying with direct heat.

Cupboard, then skirting

10. Paint the cupboard and skirting

Stir Johnstone's Quick Dry Satin. **Andy:** paint the cupboard exterior from the top down, brushing edges and using the mini roller on flat panels. **Sarah:** paint the skirting with a brush, working along the grain. In any shared corner, finish the cupboard above before painting the skirting below. Apply a thin, even coat and avoid repeatedly brushing paint that has begun to set.

11. Allow drying time before another coat

Plan for **4 hours between satin coats**, subject to the actual tin instructions. Touch dry in 1-2 hours does not mean ready for another coat. Apply a second thin coat if needed for an even finish. Keep cupboard doors ajar so painted edges do not stick together; avoid painting hinges or catches.

12. Tidy up and let the finish harden

Wash water-based paint tools as directed, close tins and label leftovers for touch-ups. Let the final coat dry overnight before handling gently or refitting handles, and longer if tacky. Return furniture carefully, keeping it clear of new paint. Avoid scrubbing walls, knocks and closing painted edges tightly while the finish hardens. Follow the tin for full curing time; overnight drying is not full cure.

Drying times at a glance

Material / stage	Allow before the next step
Washed surfaces	Until completely dry
Langlow filler	About 24 h at 20°C; longer for deep repairs
Primer, if required	The primer label's stated recoat time
Valspar grey wall paint	2-4 h listed; plan at least 4 h between coats
Johnstone's Quick Dry Satin	Plan 4 h between coats; check your tin
Final coat	Overnight before gentle handling; not full cure

Times are planning guides for normal indoor conditions. Product labels take priority. Cold, damp, thick coats and deep repairs extend drying.

Product references

B&Q: Valspar Grey Shingle Matt · Palace Chemicals: Langlow filler technical sheet
Johnstone's: Quick Dry Satin range · Quick Dry Satin range: published 4-hour recoat guidance
Satin recoat guidance is from the same product range in another colour/size; confirm the white 1.25 L tin. References checked 23 October 2026.